

## **Merseyside BMX Club - Code of Conduct**

### **Our Commitment**

Merseyside BMX Club is committed to providing a **Safe, Inclusive and Enjoyable** environment for all riders, parents/carers, coaches, volunteers and officials.

The welfare and safeguarding of our riders is our highest priority. Everyone involved in the club has a responsibility to uphold the standards set out in this Code of Conduct and to act in accordance with **British Cycling's Code of Conduct, Safeguarding Policies, Regulations and Guidance**.

This Code of Conduct applies at **training sessions, races, events, travel, online spaces**, and whenever individuals are representing Merseyside BMX Club.

### **Code of Conduct – Riders**

As a rider at Merseyside BMX Club, I agree to:

- Arrive on time and ready for training and competition.
- Wear appropriate clothing and safety equipment, including a helmet, as directed by coaches.
- Warm up and cool down properly at every session.
- Follow the rules and respect officials and their decisions.
- Show good sportsmanship and applaud good performances by all riders.
- Control my behaviour and language at all times.
- Never bully, intimidate, provoke or abuse others.
- Work hard for myself and my club.
- Respect everyone regardless of gender, ability, disability, background or religion.
- Ensure all fees are paid (by me or on my behalf).
- Not smoke, vape, drink alcohol or use drugs while at the club or representing it.
- Treat others as I expect to be treated.
- Cooperate with coaches, teammates and opponents.
- Remember that I represent Merseyside BMX Club at all times.
- Thank officials, volunteers and opponents after events when the opportunity arises.

### **Code of Conduct – Parents / Carers**

As a parent or carer at Merseyside BMX Club, I agree to:

- Support the club in maintaining a safe, inclusive and enjoyable environment.
- Ensure that my child is supervised by an appropriate adult at all times when participating in sessions. For the purpose of this policy, a child is classed as any individual under the age of 18. A parent or carer must be present at all club sessions for those under the age of 18.
- Inform the club of any medical conditions or additional needs in advance, to ensure that sessions can be adapted as needed.
- Notify coaches if my child is leaving early or being collected by someone else.

- Encourage my child to learn the rules and race fairly at all times.
- Discourage arguing with officials and any confrontational behaviour.
- Focus on effort, enjoyment and development rather than just results.
- Set a positive example through my behaviour and be mindful of the language I use eg swearing in front of children.
- Never punish or criticise a child for mistakes or losing.
- Publicly accept officials' decisions and help children do the same.
- Remember BMX is for my child's enjoyment, not mine.
- Support the removal of verbal, physical and online abuse from sport.
- Respect the rights and dignity of all riders and families.
- Show appreciation for coaches, officials and volunteers.
- Follow instructions from coaches and officials without argument.
- Remember that both my child and I represent the club at all times.
- Not smoke, vape, consume alcohol or take drugs when attending sessions at the track.

## **Code of Conduct – Coaches & Volunteers**

Coaches and volunteers at Merseyside BMX Club are expected to:

- Act in accordance with **British Cycling's Code of Conduct, Safeguarding Policies and Regulations**.
- Promote a safe, inclusive and enjoyable environment at all times.
- Act as positive role models.
- Put rider welfare and safety first.
- Support rider development at an appropriate pace.
- Never communicate directly via text message or online with a child under the age of 18.
- Never place themselves in a position where they are in a private, one to one situation with an unsupervised child.
- Have an awareness and understanding of any SEND needs that may need to be considered when planning and delivering sessions.
- Treat all riders fairly, respectfully and without discrimination.
- Create an inclusive, supportive and encouraging atmosphere.
- Use appropriate language and demonstrate positive behaviour at all times.
- Never humiliate, intimidate or abuse riders.
- Communicate clearly and respectfully with riders and parents/carers.
- Follow club safeguarding policies and British Cycling guidance.
- Raise concerns at the earliest possible opportunity with parents directly or through the Club Welfare Officer.

## **Behaviour Expectations**

- This Code of Conduct applies to **all club activities**, including training, racing, travel and online communication.
- Any behaviour that undermines our values will not be tolerated.
- Bullying, discrimination, harassment, aggressive or passive-aggressive behaviour is unacceptable.

- Social media and messaging must be respectful and must not bring individuals or the club into disrepute.
- Welfare and safeguarding concerns should be reported to the Club Welfare Officer

**Merseyside BMX Club Welfare Mailbox** – [merseysidebmxwelfare@gmail.com](mailto:merseysidebmxwelfare@gmail.com)

### **Disciplinary Action**

Where behaviour does not align with the club's values and expectations outlined above, the following steps may be taken, depending on the nature and severity of the breach:

1. Verbal reminder of expectations
2. Formal written warning
3. Suspension from training and/or events
4. Termination of membership

Serious incidents, including threatening, abusive or violent behaviour, safeguarding breaches, or conduct which brings the club into disrepute, may result in **immediate suspension**, referral to **British Cycling**, and involvement of statutory agencies where appropriate.

Merseyside BMX Club

June 2026